

the number of mobile phone subscriptions worldwide is 4.6 billion. Despite recession, there had been no drop in demand for communication services.

Cisco estimates that mobile data traffic throughout the world will reach 3.6 exabytes per month or an annual run rate of 40 exabytes, by 2014. So the amount of data traffic traversing the mobile network by 2014 will be equal to about one billion DVDs.

## Indian IT industry to grow by 5.5 per cent

Despite recession, this year will see the Indian IT industry grow by 5.5 per cent owing to greater levels of offshoring by American companies.

Also, the Indian government plans to have data centres for all states. The IT drivers for data centres are infrastructure virtualisation, desktop virtualisation, open source, open storage, Web 2.0 sharing and green IT.

## Electronics industry grew 11 per cent in 2009

The electronics industry in India registered a rise of 11 per cent in 2009. The consumer electronics sector survived the recession and grew strongly last year, thanks to the fiscal stimulus announced by the government. This growth is expected to continue this year as well, led by technology-oriented categories.

Mumbai is the top e-waste producing city in India, followed by Delhi, according to the Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB). The country's annual e-waste production is expected to increase to 800,000 tonnes by 2012. Other cities generating significant amount of e-waste are Bengaluru, Kolkata, Chennai, Ahmedabad, Hyderabad, Pune, Surat and Nagpur.

## India ranks ninth in science and technology output

With India's science and technology (S&T) systems output growing at 12 per cent against global average of just 4 per cent, the country now ranks ninth in the world's science and technology map, revealed union minister of state

## AES bags Frost & Sullivan's solar award

Atlantis Energy Systems (AES), a player in the solar domain, has bagged Frost & Sullivan's *Niche Player of the Year Award 2009* in the category of 'building-integrated photovoltaic products'. The award recognises the company's efforts in entering a niche market with innovative products and solutions as per the needs of the customers.

## GeoAmida wins social innovation award

Geodesic's GeoAmida, the world's first integrated mobile computer, has won *NASSCOM Social Innovation Honour 2010* in 'ICT-led business innovation for development' category. This award is given for innovations that result in some sort of social change and development through the application of technology.

## Wipro bags IT innovation award

Wipro Technologies has bagged *NASSCOM IT Innovation Award* in 'process innovation' category for the year 2009. Wipro received this award for its application services model—Cigma (centre for integrated global management of applications)—that enables integration of BPO, IT and device management services. Cigma integrates cutting-edge technology and

for science and technology Prithviraj Chavan recently. India has overtaken Spain by moving one rank up from last year's rating. The country was ranked 15th in S&T systems output in 2002.

The government is looking at science to create wealth and employment for the country and the next ten years have been dedicated to innovation in science and technology.

## India high on solar power

India's solar photovoltaic (PV) module production capacity has crossed more than 1 gigawatt (GW) per year or nearly 10 per cent of the global production capacity.

The government is now seeking cheap storage for solar power. Farooq Abdullah, the union minister for new and renewable energy, has announced

process elements to deliver stability of the client's business platform at a lower cost, according to Wipro.

## Mouser wins high service award

Mouser Electronics has won *Honeywell Sensing & Control 2009 High Service Authorized Distribution Award*. It was recognised for its ability to quickly launch Honeywell Sensing and Control's newest products through a combination of online processes and print marketing techniques.

## IIT Madras announces the names of alumnus award recipients

For *Distinguished Alumnus Award (DAA) 2010*, IIT Madras has named the following as this year's recipients: Prof. V. Ramamurthy (Department of Chemistry, University of Miami), Prof. Subbarayan Pasupathy (Department of Electrical & Computer Engineering, University of Toronto), Prof. Suresh V. Garimela (Department of Mechanical Engineering, Purdue University), Dr P. Chellapandi (associate director, Nuclear Engineering Group, IGCAR), Dr Lalit Chordia (president & CEO, Thar Technologies, Pittsburgh and Chennai), Dr P. Anandan (MD, Microsoft Research, India) and R. Sri Kumar (retired head, Karnataka Police Force).

Nomination is now open for the 2011 DA Awards. Please visit <http://alumni.iitm.ac.in/DAA.html> for further details.

plans to begin research targeted at reducing the cost of storing solar energy for the national solar mission.

Says Hemanth Nayak, industry analyst, Frost & Sullivan, "Several private firms are expected to make large investments to avail financial incentives and leverage the cost advantages of solar PV production in India.

## Semiconductor policy launched for Karnataka

The semiconductor policy 2010 for Karnataka is focused on promoting electronics system design and manufacturing. The assembly, testing, marking and packaging units would be provided fiscal incentives and concessions, such as investment subsidy, exemption from stamp duty and entry tax, and interest-free loan on VAT. For